

Bug B1 – Story 3 (invalid TODO update)

Executive summary

Invalid TODO update payload returns 200 instead of validation error

Description

When updating a TODO using `/todos/{id}` with an invalid payload (for example an empty JSON body that omits all fields), the REST API returns status 200 OK and accepts the request instead of rejecting it with a 400 validation error. Our Story 3 error-flow test (“Update a TODO with invalid data”) shows that the server treats the missing fields as acceptable, which is inconsistent with the stricter validation used in other endpoints.

Potential impact

Clients may believe invalid update requests succeeded, leaving TODO items in an inconsistent or partially updated state. This makes it harder to reason about which fields are required and may hide client-side bugs. It also breaks the expectation that invalid payloads always produce a 4xx error, making error handling and logging less reliable.

Steps to reproduce

1. Start the REST API:
`java -jar runTodoManagerRestAPI-1.5.5.jar`
2. Create a TODO (or use the one from Story 3 Background, for example “Read textbook”).
3. Send an HTTP POST request to update that TODO with an empty body:
`curl -i -X POST http://localhost:4567/todos/{id} -H "Content-Type: application/json" -d '{}'`
4. Observe that the response has status 200 OK instead of a 400 validation error.
5. This behaviour is exercised in Part B Story 3 – Update a TODO description (Error Flow / BUG).